Findings Tottenham Hotspur Women

Clustering results

For k = 2, Spurs were safely clustered as a patient team. However, at k = 3 and k = 4, they switched to central combiners, but only just.

Like patient teams

Spurs stand out for less progression by passing but more by carrying than most patient teams. They were less direct and more patient on their attacks. More of their shots came from open play but less from direct set piece, while less of their box entries were via passes, especially with crosses. They defended lower and counterpress less on opposition half.

In short, build up and defending were what made Spurs looked like a patient team.

Like central combiners

Spurs had much higher shares of final third entries and touches centrally while lower on the right. They attempted much more through balls than average.

Pitch profile

Left and right entries and touches in the final third were roughly equal. Almost 30% of Spurs' final third entries and touches were central.

Formations and typical XI

Only three formations were used by Spurs throughout the season, with 4-2-3-1 being the main option, followed by 4-4-2 and 4-4-1-1.

For their 4-2-3-1 setup, regular options include Spencer at goalkeeper, Bartrip at left center back, Summanen as one of the defensive midfielders, Bizet at right wing, and Thomas at striker. Right center back was a close 50-50 split, while Neville was a regular option for both left back and right back. Clinton was regularly used both as an attacking midfielder and left winger, while Naz was rotated between winger and center forward. Ahtinen was often the second defensive midfielder.

Similar teams

Only Koln was close on squad, while Pomigliano was close on style. No teams were genuinely close to Spurs overall.

Appendix

The full Spurs team report (PDF).